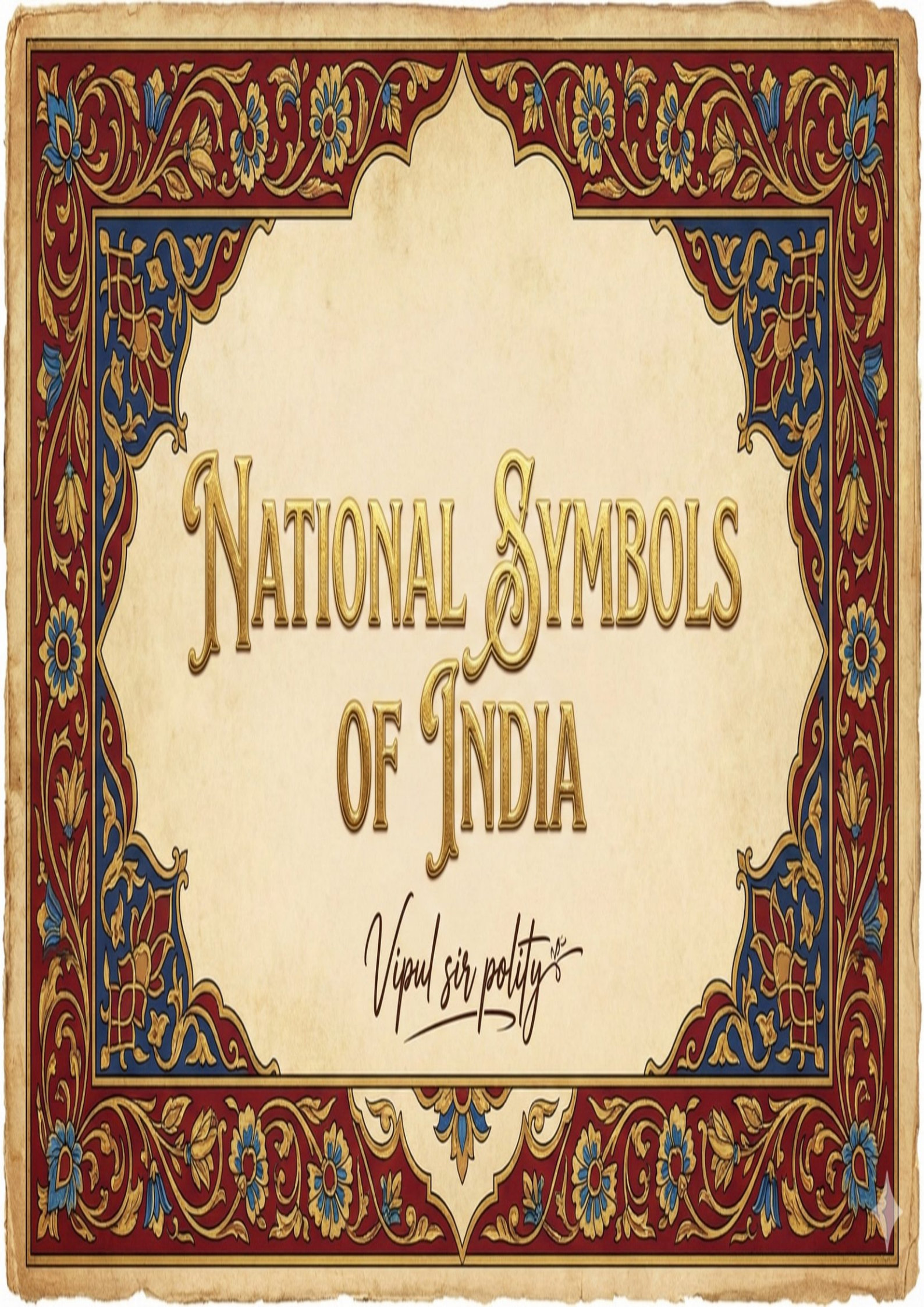




# NATIONAL SYMBOLS OF INDIA

*Vipul sir polity*



# Symbols of India

## THE FACETS OF NATIONAL IDENTITY

A visual guide to the State, Nature, and Culture of the Indian Republic



A nation is defined by the symbols it chooses to represent its past, present, and future. This collection explores the official insignia, living heritage, and celebratory spirit that constitute the Republic of India.

## The Insignia of State

### Political Identity & Governance

The foundational symbols of the Republic, born from the freedom struggle and enshrined in the birth of the nation.

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# National Flag (Tiranga)

**Adoption:** 22 July 1947 (Constituent Assembly)

**Design History:** Evolved from Pingali Venkayya's 1921 spinning wheel design. Final form adopted in 1947 with the Ashoka Chakra.

## The Meaning

- **Saffron:** Courage, sacrifice, and the spirit of renunciation.
- **White:** Peace, truth, and transparency.
- **Green:** Faith, fertility, growth, and prosperity.
- **Ashoka Chakra:** The Wheel of Dharma representing continuous progress.

### Did You Know?

- **Ratio:** 3:2 (Length to Height)
- **Law:** Governed by the Flag Code of India (2002). Must not touch the ground or be used as drapery.

# State Emblem of India

The Lion Capital of Ashoka

## Identity Data

**Origin:** Sarnath, c. 250 BCE (Erected under Emperor Ashoka)

**Adoption:** 26 January 1950

## The Soul / Meaning

- **The Lions:** Symbolize power, courage, confidence, and a message spreading in all directions.
- **The Wheel:** The Dharmachakra representing righteous rule.
- **The Motto:** 'Satyameva Jayate' (Truth Alone Triumphs) - sourced from the Mundaka Upanishad.



Abacus features the Elephant (strength), Bull (duty), Horse (energy), and Lion (bravery).





## National Anthem

# Jana Gana Mana

**Author:** Rabindranath Tagore (1911)

**Adoption:** 24 January 1950

**Key Fact:** Standard duration is approx. 52 seconds.

**Status:** Protected under the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971.



## National Song

# Vande Mataram

**Author:** Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay (1882)

**Adoption:** 24 January 1950

**History:** A major nationalist slogan during the Swadeshi movement.

**Context:** Written in Sanskritised Bengali. Only the first two stanzas are used officially to maintain civic inclusivity.

## National Calendar: The Saka Era



Adopted in 1957.

The Saka Era begins in 78 CE.

The year starts on 22 March (21 March in leap years).

Represents the continuity of Indian chronological tradition.

## National Currency: Indian Rupee (₹)

Symbol adopted in 2010.

Designed by D. Udaya Kumar.

It is a blend of the Devanagari "Ra" and Roman "R", signifying Indian identity and global usability.

The concept of the "rupiya" dates back to Sher Shah Suri in the 16th Century.



# The Living Heritage

## Flora, Fauna, and Ecology

The natural avatars of the nation—flora and fauna that represent the strength, beauty, and biodiversity of the Indian subcontinent.



## National Animal: Bengal Tiger

*Panthera tigris tigris*

### Identity Data

- Recognition: Associated with the launch of Project Tiger in 1973.
- Origin: Native species with prehistoric biological origins.

### The Soul / Meaning

- Symbolizes strength, courage, and majesty.
- Represents India's dedication to wildlife conservation.

Project Tiger:  
Launched in 1973 under  
Indira Gandhi, this  
initiative put India on the  
global map for species  
conservation.



# National Bird: Indian Peacock

*Pavo cristatus*

- Recognition: 1963
- Origin: Native species

## The Soul / Meaning

- Represents beauty, grace, and vibrancy.
- Holds a strong presence in Indian art, mythology, and tradition.



## National Heritage Animal

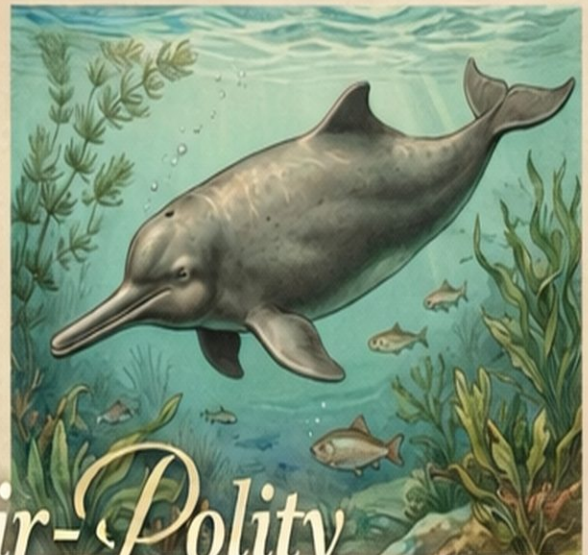
*Indian Elephant (Elephas maximus indicus)*



Declared in 2010. Represents ecological heritage and conservation priority.

## National Aquatic Animal

*Ganges River Dolphin (Platanista gangetica)*



Declared in 2009. A symbol of biodiversity and an indicator of river health (survives only in pure freshwater).

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## National Flower

*Lotus (Nelumbo nucifera)*



Symbol of purity, resilience, and spiritual awakening. It blooms cleanly above the mud.

## National Tree

*Indian Banyan (Ficus benghalensis)*



Symbol of longevity, immortality, and unity. Its expanding canopy represents shelter.

## National Fruit

*Mango (Mangifera indica)*

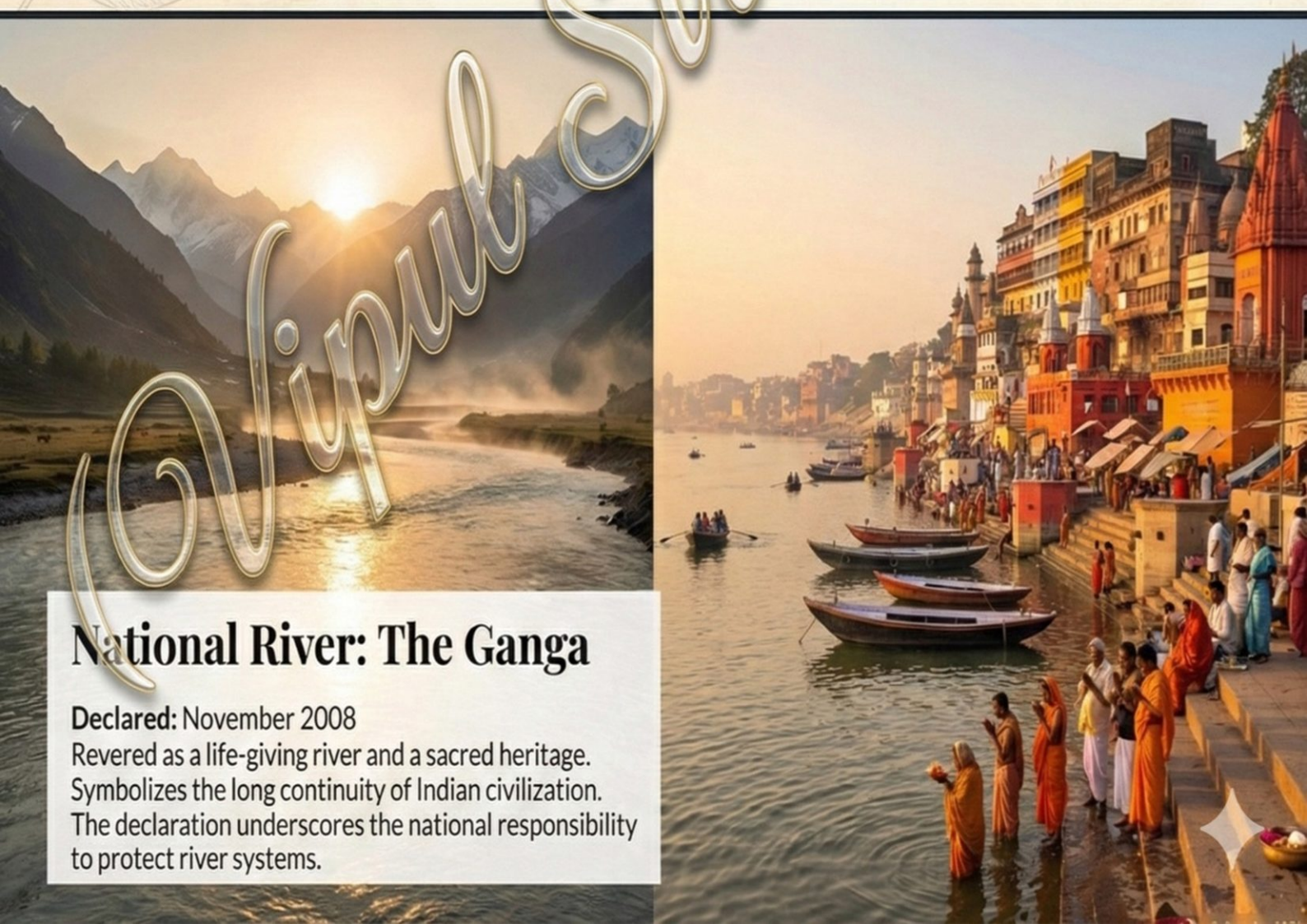


Symbol of abundance, prosperity, and agricultural richness.

## National River: The Ganga

**Declared:** November 2008

Revered as a life-giving river and a sacred heritage. Symbolizes the long continuity of Indian civilization. The declaration underscores the national responsibility to protect river systems.

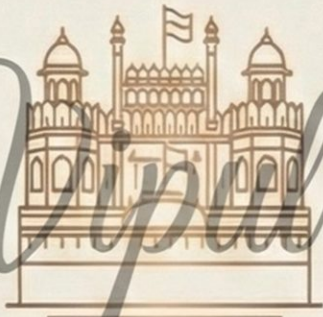




# The Days of the Republic

Independence Day

**15 August**



**Adoption:** 15 Aug 1947

**Trigger:** Indian Independence Act  
(Royal Assent 18 July 1947)

**Event:** Prime Minister hoists the  
flag at the Red Fort.

Republic Day

**26 January**

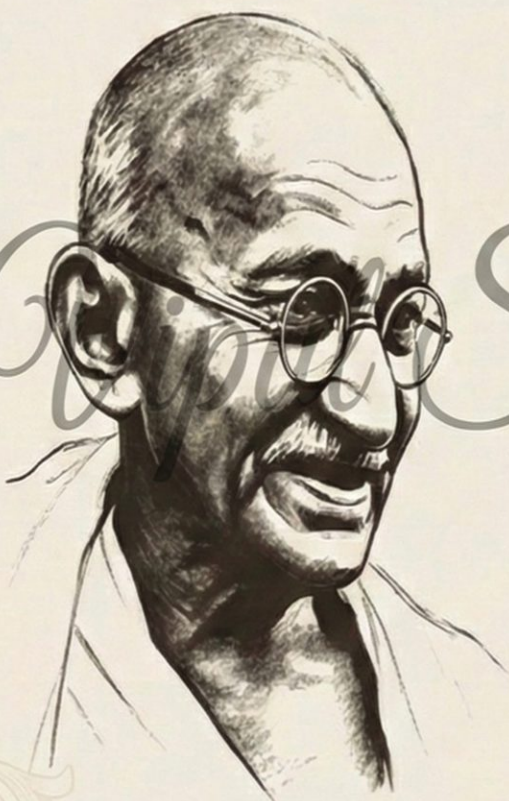


**Adoption:** 26 Jan 1950

**Trigger:** Constitution of India  
came into force.

**Event:** Grand Parade in New  
Delhi celebrating democracy.

## The Legacy of Non-Violence



**\*\*Gandhi Jayanti\*\***

**(2 October)**

**Origin:** Birth of Mahatma Gandhi (1869).

**Global Context**

**International Recognition:**  
Designated as the **International  
Day of Non-Violence** by the UN.

**UN Adoption:** 15 June 2007.



# The Cultural Tapestry

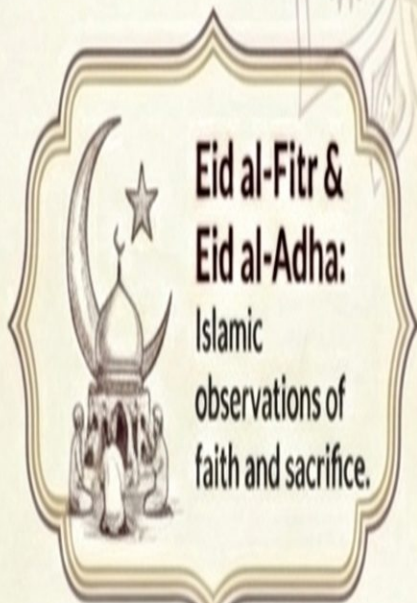
While not official state symbols, these festivals are intrinsic to the national identity.



**Diwali:**  
The Festival of  
Lights. Associated  
with Rama, Sita,  
and Lakshmi.



**Holi:**  
The Festival  
of Colors.  
Celebrating the  
victory of good  
over evil.



**Eid al-Fitr &  
Eid al-Adha:**  
Islamic  
observations of  
faith and sacrifice.



**Christmas:**  
Celebrating the  
birth of Jesus  
Christ on 25  
December.



**Durga Puja /  
Navratri:**  
Celebration of  
Shakti and the  
victory of  
Goddess Durga.



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# The National Symbols: Quick Reference

| Symbol   | Adoption Date | Key Detail                   |
|----------|---------------|------------------------------|
| Flag     | 22 July 1947  | Designed by Pingali Venkayya |
| Anthem   | 24 Jan 1950   | Written by Tagore (52 sec)   |
| Song     | 24 Jan 1950   | Written by Bankim Chandra    |
| Emblem   | 26 Jan 1950   | Sarnath Lion Capital         |
| Calendar | 1957          | Saka Era (78 CE)             |
| Tiger    | 1973          | Project Tiger                |
| Rupee    | 2010          | Designer D. Udaya Kumar      |
| Elephant | 2010          | Heritage Animal              |

## Unity in Diversity



“From the roar of the Tiger to the silence of the Lotus,  
and from the ancient Vedas to the modern  
Constitution—these symbols are the threads that weave  
the diverse fabric of India into a single nation.”